

Antistreptolysin O (ASO) Antibodies

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Latex immunoturbidimetry

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

1 - 2 days

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Use

Document exposure to streptococcal streptolysin O. A marked rise in titer or a persistently elevated titer indicates that a *Streptococcus* infection or poststreptococcal sequelae are present.

Limitations

False-positive ASO titers can be caused by increased levels of serum β -lipoprotein produced in liver disease and by contamination of the serum with *Bacillus cereus* and *Pseudomonas* sp ASO titers are elevated in 85% of patients with rheumatic fever but may not be elevated in cases involving skin or renal sequelae. For patients suffering from skin or renal involvement, anti-DNase B test (096289) (</tests/096289/anti-dnase-b-streptococcal-antibodies>) may be a better choice.

Custom Additional Information

Streptolysin is a hemolysin produced by group A streptococci. In an infected individual streptolysin O acts as a protein antigen, and the patient mounts an antibody response. A rise in antibody level begins about one week after infection and peaks two to three weeks later. In the absence of complications or reinfection, the ASO titer will usually fall to preinfection levels within 6 to 12 months. Both clinical and laboratory findings should be correlated in reaching a diagnosis.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum

Volume

2 mL

Minimum Volume

0.5 mL (**Note:** This volume does **not** allow for repeat testing.)

Container

Red-top tube or gel-barrier tube

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	14 days
Refrigerated	14 days
Frozen	14 days
Freeze/thaw cycles	Stable x3

Reference Range

0.0–200.0 IU/mL

Storage Instructions

Room temperature

Causes for Rejection

Gross hemolysis; lipemia
